

ATLAS
COMICS



ISSUE

07

\$4.99

HORIZON
BEYOND THE WHITE

NEEL



CRAAAAASH

THE MERIDIAN
IS UNFORGIVING.

ROCK. STEEL.
WILL.



FEAR IS
A LUXURY.



FOCUS IS
SURVIVAL.



STARBOARD WINCHES,
TAKE STRAIN!



AYE!



BLACK SPIRE
AT TWO BELLS.

CURRENT SHIFTING
SOUTH BY EAST.

GOOD.



LET'S
GIVE IT
SOMETHING
TO REMEMBER
US BY.



Crosswind
force, port side—
47 knots and
climbing.

Hull stress,
critical but
holding.

This ship was
built to break
through.

Not to bow.



Hold
the line!

We cut
through—
or we don't
come back!



Aye, Captain!

Line's
set!



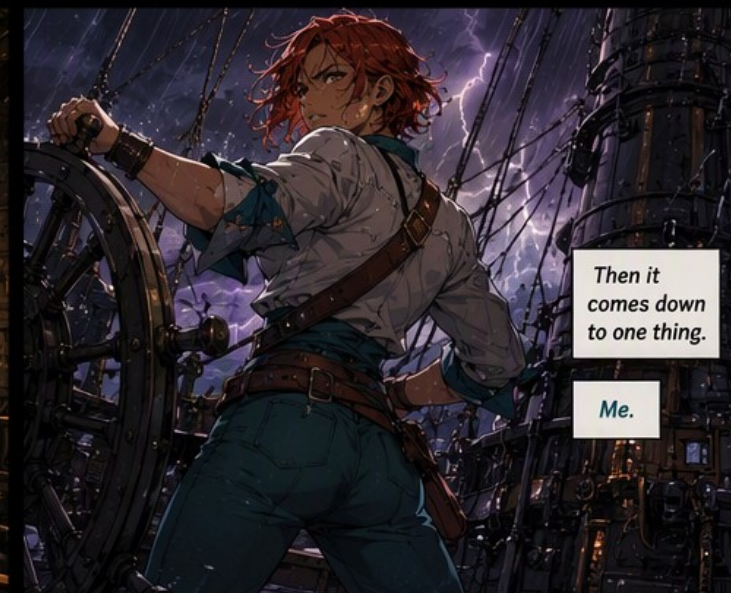
Storm's
getting
meaner.

Good.



Power's
steady.

Crew's
sharp.



Then it
comes down
to one thing.

Me.



THE WHITE.

NO HORIZON.
NO SKY.
NO DISTANCE.

JUST THE END
OF EVERYTHING.



ALL
HANDS!



NO SOUND.
NOT EVEN
THE WIND.



THE CREW
LOOKS.
THEY WAIT.



ORDERS
MEAN NOTHING
AGAINST
NOTHINGNESS.
AND YET—

--WE
MOVE
FORWARD.



...!



WHAT IS
THAT...?



NO IDEA.
BUT SHE
KNOWS.
WE FOLLOW.



THREE DAYS
OUT OF HALCYON.

THREE DAYS INTO
A SKY THAT WANTS
SOMETHING IN RETURN.

AS IF THE STORM
WEREN'T WARNING
ENOUGH.



THEN IT CAME.

NOT ON THE WIND.
NOT ON THE RADAR.

IN THE SILENCE
BETWEEN.



SOMETHING
WRONG.

SOMETHING
IMPOSSIBLE.



A HORIZON
WITHOUT SKY.

A WHITE THAT
SHOULD NOT BE.

A VOID
WEARING LIGHT.



MY HAND
FORGOT
ITS PURPOSE.



MY BREATH
FORGOT TO
RETURN.



AND MY MIND...

IT KNEW.



WHATEVER THAT IS—
IT IS NOT THE STORM.

IT IS THE REASON
THE STORM EXISTS.

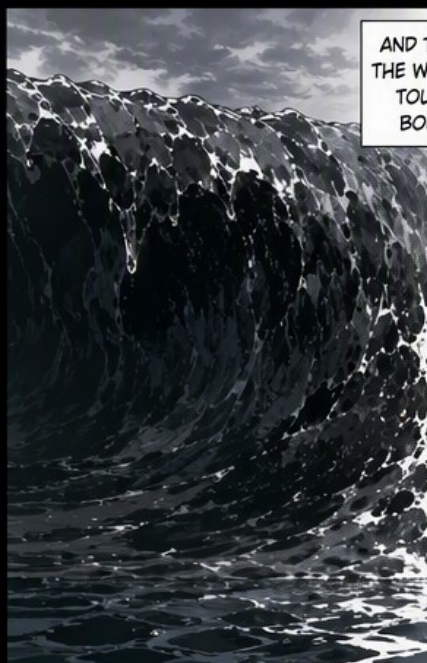
A SIXTY-FOOT WAVE
OF DENSE MERCURY-
HEAVY WATER CURLS
FORWARD TOWARD
THE FLAT WHITE
VOID AHEAD.



A LOW, HEAVILY
ARMORED SAILING
SHIP BUILT TO
PUNCH THROUGH
WAVES RATHER
THAN RIDE THEM.



AND THE INSTANT
THE WAVE'S CREST
TOUCHES THE
BOUNDARY...



IT SIMPLY
CLIPS OUT
OF EXISTENCE
ALONG A
PERFECTLY
SHEER EDGE.

NO SPLASH.
NO SPRAY.
JUST AN
ABRUPT
ABSENCE
WHERE SOLID
WATER USED
TO BE.



WH-
WHAT THE
HELL-?!





A CHILD'S
HAND.

A ROPE
SLIPPING FREE.

GONE WITHOUT
A SOUND.

THE SEA
REMEMBERS.

NOT TODAY.

I WON'T
LOSE ANOTHER
SOUL TO
THIS SEA.



THE STORM
DOESN'T CARE
WHO YOU ARE.

ONLY WHAT
YOU'RE WILLING
TO BECOME.



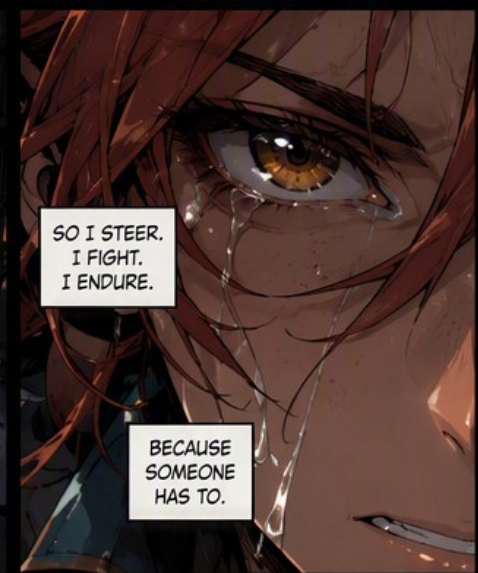
I WASN'T
BORN CAPTAIN.

I EARNED IT
IN BLOOD
AND SALT.



THE SEA TAKES,
BUT IT ALSO
REVEALS.

IT SHOWS YOU
WHAT YOU'RE
MADE OF.



SO I STEER.
I FIGHT.
I ENDURE.

BECAUSE
SOMEONE
HAS TO.

THE MAPS
CALL IT
THE WHITE
NOTHING.

NO COASTS.
NO SIGNALS.

JUST ENDLESS
BLANK.

SOME SHIPS
WERE BUILT TO
RUN FROM IT.

OURS WAS
BUILT FOR
THIS.

STEEL KEEL.
OAKEN SPINE.

WE DON'T RIDE
THE WAVES—

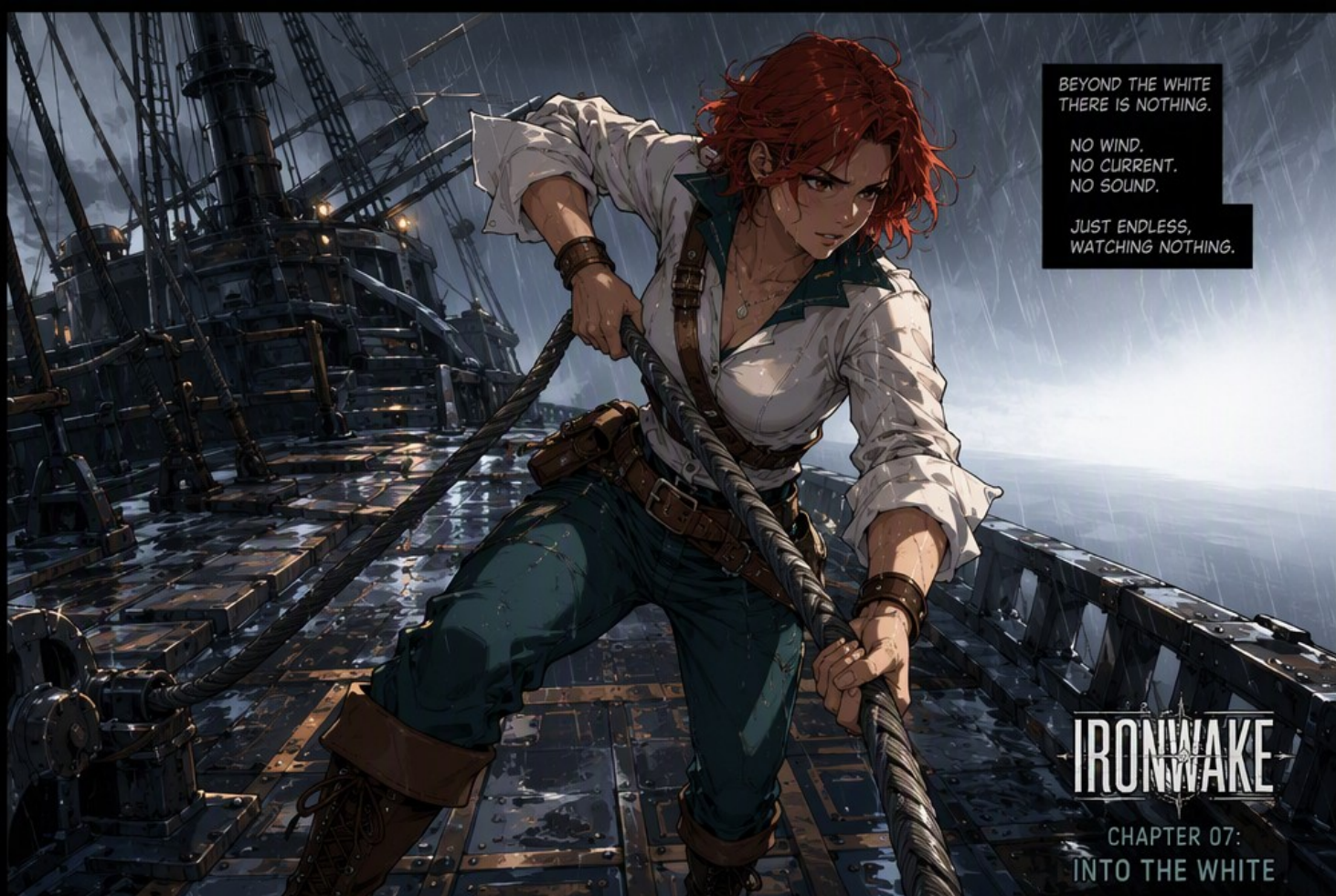
WE PUNCH
THROUGH THEM.



SHOW ME
WHAT YOU
ARE!







BEYOND THE WHITE
THERE IS NOTHING.

NO WIND.
NO CURRENT.
NO SOUND.

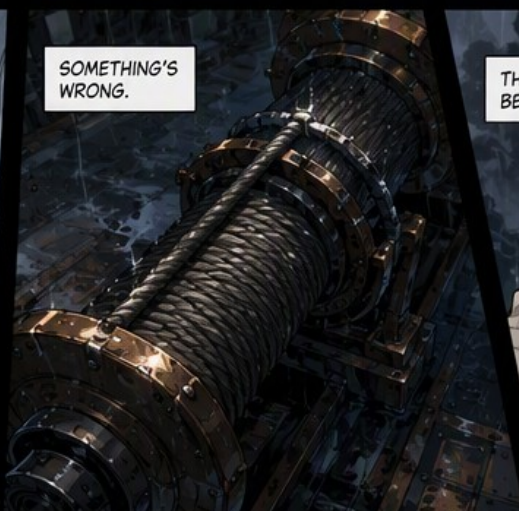
JUST ENDLESS,
WATCHING NOTHING.

IRONWAKE

CHAPTER 07:
INTO THE WHITE



CABLE'S SLACK.
TOO SLACK.



SOMETHING'S
WRONG.



THIS CAN'T
BE RIGHT.



THE WHITE
HASN'T MOVED.
HAS IT?



THE
HARPOON HEAD...
SHEARED CLEAN
AWAY.



NO BURN.
NO MARK.
NOTHING.

JUST...
GONE.



WHATEVER
DID THIS...
IT DIDN'T
WANT A CLEAN
CUT.



IT WANTED
SILENCE.



SOMEONE
DIDN'T WANT US
CHASING WHAT
WENT DOWN
HERE.

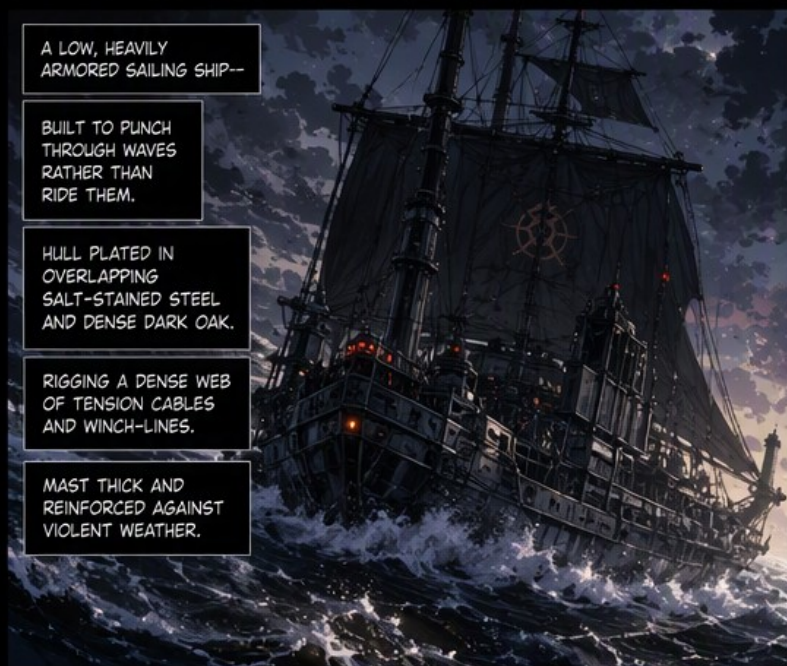


THE STORM BEGINS
TO BREAK APART...

...INTO RAGGED
VIOLET CLOUDS.

THE WHITE VOID
SHRINKS.

BEHIND US.



A LOW, HEAVILY
ARMORED SAILING SHIP--

BUILT TO PUNCH
THROUGH WAVES
RATHER THAN
RIDE THEM.

HULL PLATED IN
OVERLAPPING
SALT-STAINED STEEL
AND DENSE DARK OAK.

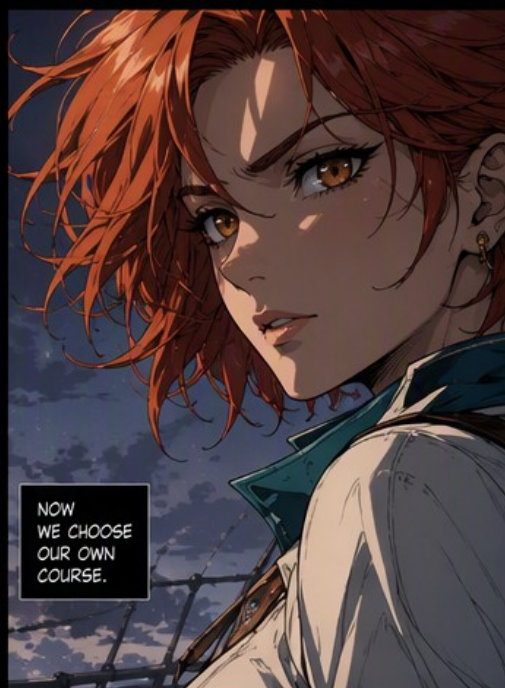
RIGGING A DENSE WEB
OF TENSION CABLES
AND WINCH-LINES.

MAST THICK AND
REINFORCED AGAINST
VIOLENT WEATHER.



THE
HARPOON
HAS DONE
ITS WORK.

ITS HEAD
SEVERED.



NOW
WE CHOOSE
OUR OWN
COURSE.



THE VOID
BEHIND US.

THE FUTURE
AHEAD.

STEADY
AS THE KEEL
BENEATH
MY FEET.



THE CALM
BEFORE THE
EMBER STORM.

THREE ISLANDS.
ONE CONTRACT.

LET'S SEE WHAT
THE HORIZON
IS HIDING.

STEADY
COURSE.

WHATEVER
COMES...

...WE
MEET IT
TOGETHER.

CHUNK...

CHUNK...

Open Sea.
No Coast.
No Mercy.



Most
People
Fear the
Dark.

I Trust
It More
Than the
Light.

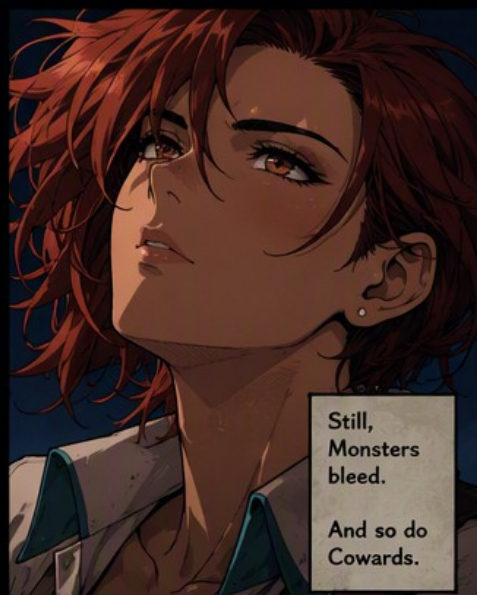
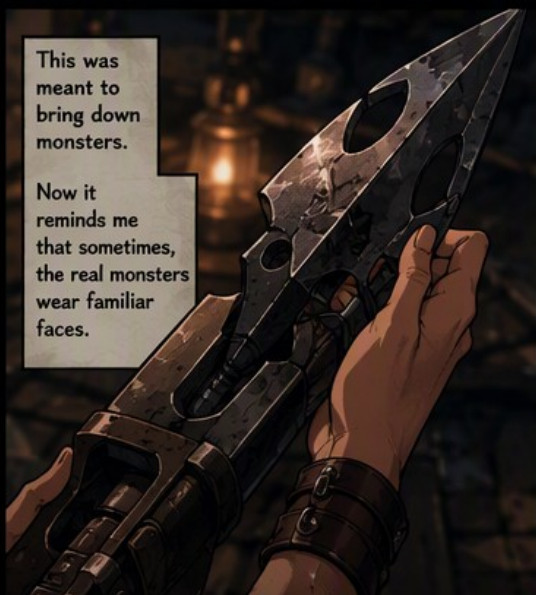


Out here,
it's just
you,
the ship,
and the
choices
you make.



This was
meant to
bring down
monsters.

Now it
reminds me
that sometimes,
the real monsters
wear familiar
faces.



Still,
Monsters
bleed.

And so do
Cowards.



HARBINGER

MAY THE SEA REMEMBER.

DAWN.
THE VOLCANIC
CHAIN OF ASHEN
CROWN.

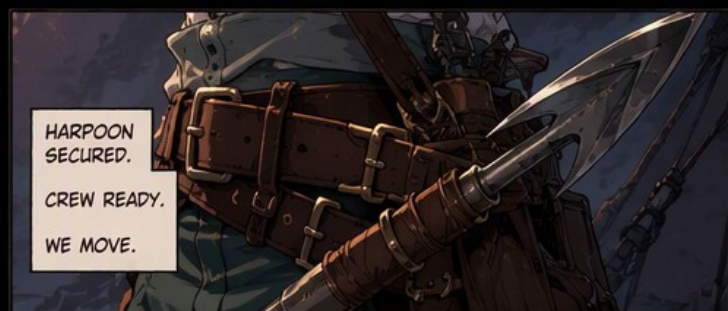
CLOSER NOW.
CLOSE ENOUGH TO
SEE THE FIRE
BREATHING BENEATH
THE STONE.



THE CHARTS CALL
THEM UNSTABLE.
THE LOCALS CALL
THEM CURSED.
I CALL THEM
OPPORTUNITY.



HARPOON
SECURED.
CREW READY.
WE MOVE.



ALL HANDS.
PREPARE FOR
APPROACH.



ASHEN CROWN.
LET'S SEE WHAT
YOU'RE HIDING.

